

these universities was collected on the six parameters. The universities that did not provide the factual data were not considered in the final ranking process. All factual information was rescaled and then aggregated to get an overall factual score.

Step 5: The weightage of perceptual and factual information based on the opinions of the experts after Step 3 was then calculated. To get the overall score for the universities, a weightage of 40 per cent was applied to the overall perceptual score and 60 per cent to overall factual scores.

After assigning this weightage, the overall score was indexed to 100. Thus the methodology of ranking, based on both perceptual and factual data, provides a comprehensive picture of each university rated.

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supply the manpower needed to make the country's contributions to the knowledge economy sought-after, meaningful and profitable.

For this to happen, though the Government states that India's gross enrolment ratio in higher education will have to rise from 12.4 per cent (12.4 students from every 100 pursuing higher education) to 30 per cent. The Union Human Resource Development (HRD) Minister, Kapil Sibal, was quoted as saying, "An additional 600 universities and 35,000 colleges will be required over the coming 12 years." These are staggering, daunting numbers, but for India to stay competitive, this is the pace at which it must operate. Higher education is a key focus area and over the next year, the subject will be pushed forward by the HRD Ministry, causing controversy and stirring debate.

India's university education is meant to give our soft-power economy even more of a cutting-edge over the next decade. This is why INDIA TODAY decided to find out where our leading higher education institutions stand today. To identify India's top 50 universities, its centres of excellence in the knowledge business, we worked towards introducing INDIA TODAY's Top University rankings, in partnership with The Nielsen Company. Just like our India's Best Colleges Survey has become widely accepted as the country's most comprehensive database of under-graduate studies, the University rankings intend to become the benchmark for our post-graduate education.

The idea was to identify institutions which broad-base post-graduate studies through a multi-stream approach, in arts, science and commerce. Institutions which offer courses in a range of streams, not merely one branch of knowledge, were part of the survey. The methodology explains how in all 140 universities, a mix of Central, state and a few deemed universities were included.

Rankings, it is known, please only very few, except those that find their way at the top. Or in this case, at the very top. Like the Banaras Hindu University (BHU), which has emerged at the top of the INDIA TODAY-Nielsen rank-

504

universities and 25,951 colleges, including 2,565 women colleges, in India.

136.42

lakh students get enrolled in various universities and colleges.

56.49

lakh is the total enrolment of women students in the country and the highest is 8 lakh in Uttar Pradesh.

5.89

lakh is the regular faculty strength—0.90 lakh in universities and 4.99 lakh in colleges.

Source: Ministry of Human Resource Development Report, 2009-10

ings of India's top 50 universities. The difference between BHU and the other leading post-graduate institutions is reflected in the difference in their rankings, both perceptual and factual, against the rest. This indicates both BHU's status amongst academicians and educationists as well facilities available for the students. For example, the BHU offers 1,703 post-graduate courses, as opposed to 987 in the Jawaharlal Nehru University (JNU), which does not offer post-graduate commerce courses,